Ground Handling Bulletin GHB-26-14: Winter De-icing and Anti-icing Operations

Effective date	1 November 2026
Applies to	All stations; ATR 72-600 and Dash 8-400 fleets
Supersedes	GHB-25-09
Issued by	Head of Ground Operations

1. Purpose

This bulletin sets out the procedures that all stations and contracted handling agents must follow when aircraft are de-iced or anti-iced during the 2026–27 winter season. It replaces the previous bulletin in full and must be read together with the Ground Operations Manual, chapter 9.

2. Responsibilities

- The station manager ensures that only trained and authorised staff apply fluids.
- The de-icing lead decides the treatment method and records the start time of the final step.
- The commander remains responsible for deciding whether the aircraft is fit to take off.

3. Holdover times

Holdover time is the estimated period during which the anti-icing fluid prevents frost, ice or snow from forming on the treated surfaces. The table below is reproduced for training purposes; in operation, always use the current holdover-time guidelines issued for the season.

Table 1. Indicative holdover times for training use

OAT (°C)	Fluid	Holdover time (h:mm)			
		Freezing fog	Light snow	Freezing drizzle	Light freezing rain
−3 and above	Type I	0:11–0:17	0:06–0:11	0:05–0:09	0:02–0:05
	Type IV 100/0	1:05–2:10	0:35–1:05	0:40–1:10	0:25–0:40
Below −3 to −14	Type I	0:08–0:13	0:05–0:09	0:04–0:07	0:02–0:05
	Type IV 100/0	0:50–1:40	0:25–0:50	0:20–0:45	0:15–0:30
Below −14 to −25	Type IV 100/0	0:20–0:55	0:15–0:30	—	—

> Holdover time begins at the start of the final application of fluid, not at its end.

4. Communication with the flight crew

Before the aircraft leaves the de-icing pad, the de-icing lead must pass the anti-icing code to the commander by radio or by ACARS. Messages sent by ACARS must follow the format below exactly.

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DEICE/ANTI-ICE REPORT
FLT KRA2417   ACFT G-ZKRA   STN EXT
FLUID   TYPE IV 100/0
START   0642Z (FINAL STEP)
INSP    POST-TREATMENT CHECK COMPLETED
CODE    IV/100/0642/COMPLETE
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The commander confirms receipt by repeating the fluid type and the start time.

5. Pre-departure checklist

- ☐ Contamination check carried out on wings, tail and control surfaces
- ☐ Fluid type and concentration confirmed against the batch sheet
- ☐ Start time of the final step recorded
- ☐ Anti-icing code passed to the commander
- ☐ Post-treatment check signed by the de-icing lead

6. Reporting

Any fluid spill, equipment failure or missed holdover time must be reported through the safety reporting system before the end of the shift. Stations send a weekly summary of de-icing movements to Ground Operations every Monday.

Approved by: Head of Ground Operations, 20 October 2026